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GenAI apps doubled their revenue, grew to 1.7B downloads in first half of 2025

Ivan Mehta — 7:14 AM PDT · July 30, 2025

Generative AI apps have seen tremendous growth in both downloads and in-app revenue in the first half of 2025, [a report](#) from market intelligence firm [Sensor Tower](#) said. Users downloaded GenAI apps 1.7 billion times, compared to 1 billion in H2 2024. These apps doubled in-app revenue, bringing in \$1.87 billion in H1 2025, as compared to \$932 million in H2 2024.

The report noted that users spent over 15.6 billion hours on GenAI apps in the first half of 2025, a jump from 8.5 billion hours in H2 2024. This time was recorded over 426 billion sessions.

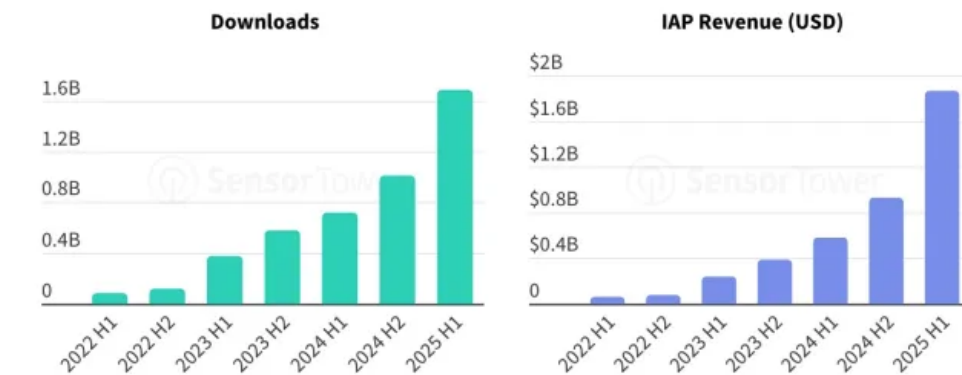


IMAGE CREDITS:SENSOR TOWER

Asia was the fastest-growing market for GenAI apps, and also took the lead for market share in terms of downloads with 42.6%, thanks to markets like India and Mainland China. Download growth in Asia was 80% in H1 2025, as compared to 51% in Europe and 39% in North America.

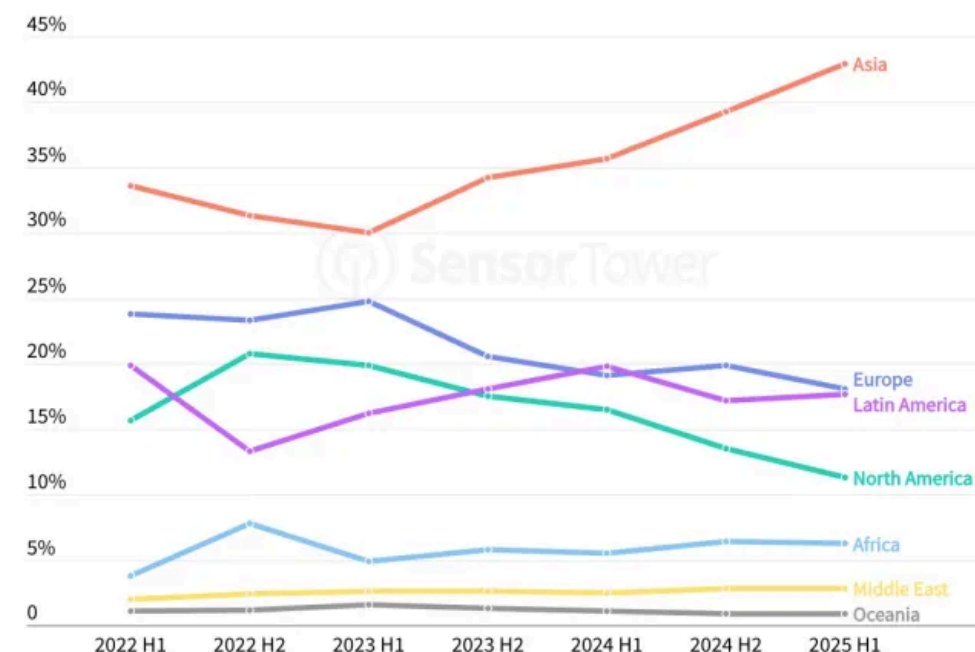


IMAGE CREDITS:SENSOR TOWER

While LatAm registered the highest growth for in-app purchases for GenAI apps, North America still holds the lead in terms of market share with 40%.

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ChatGPT’s continued growth

Sensor Tower noted that ChatGPT was the leading app for in-app revenue in every country, bar China. However, China’s DeepSeek performed better in terms of the number of downloads in weeks after the launch.

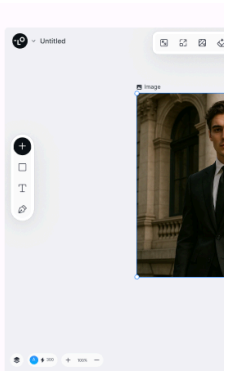
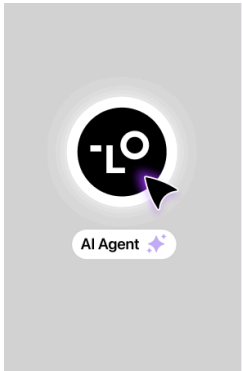
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People are also spending more time with different AI assistants, with ChatGPT leading the pack. People used the app for more than 12 days on average in a month for H1. Other popular apps were Character AI, PolyBuzz, DeepSeek, and Perplexity.

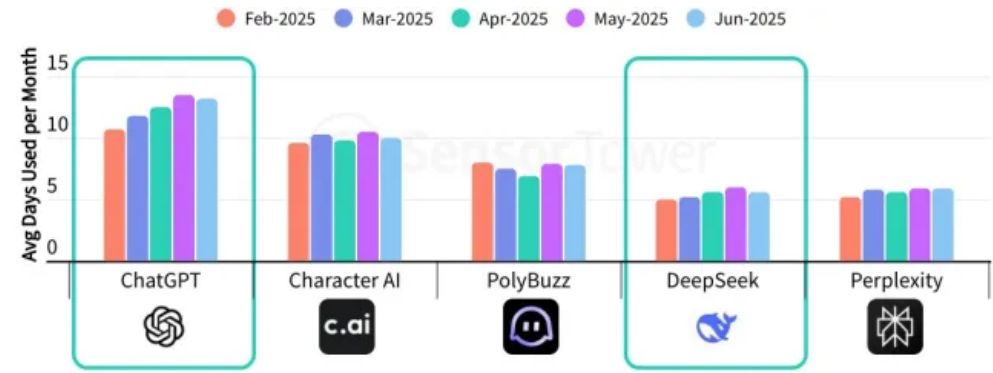


IMAGE CREDITS: SENSOR TOWER

ChatGPT’s stickiness has been impressive. Sensor Tower said that people are using OpenAI’s app as much as X and Reddit. Only Google has a better rate for the average number of days used per month. The report also mentioned that, as compared to last year, ChatGPT’s weekend usage has also improved, signaling that people are relying on the AI-powered chat app beyond work.

Average Number of Days Used per Month for ChatGPT vs. Select Social Apps

Android Phones, Worldwide

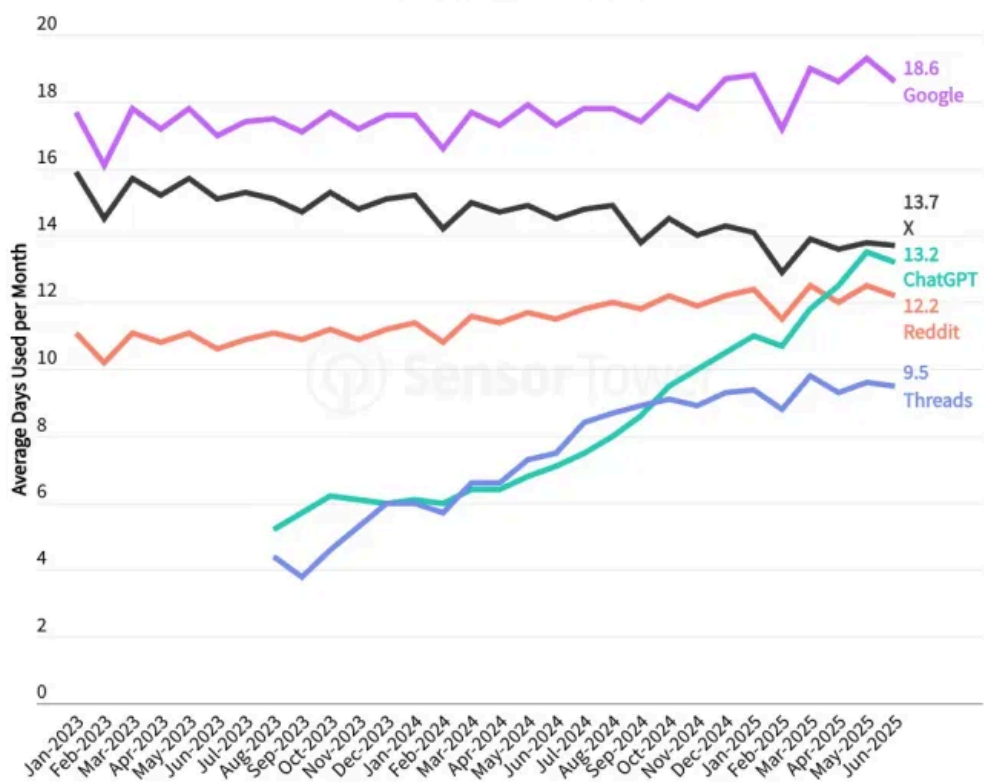


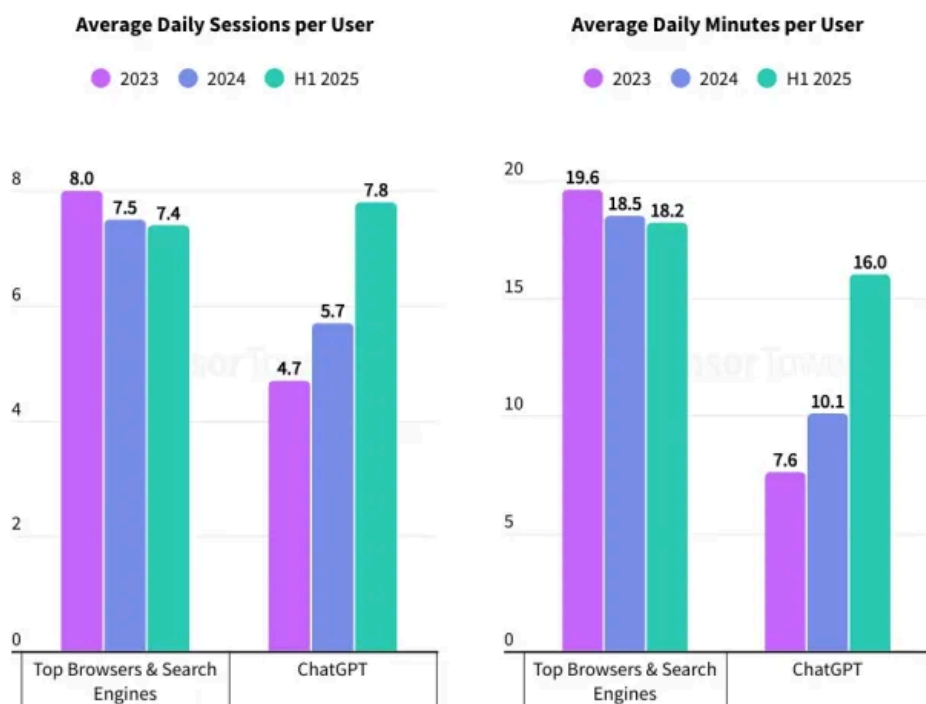
IMAGE CREDITS: SENSOR TOWER

“This development makes its app usage patterns more akin to Google’s, which consumers rely on as a primary search tool both during and outside of work hours,” the report said.

Over time, the gap between usage of ChatGPT and usage of apps in the top search engine and browser categories has decreased. For instance, in H1 2025, ChatGPT had 16 minutes of average daily usage as compared to 18.2 minutes for the top search engine and browser.

Browser & Search Engine App Engagement vs. ChatGPT

Worldwide, iOS and Google Play



Beyond search, users are also using ChatGPT for health and wellness, shopping, personal finance, and meal prep advice. The report said that more than a third of prompts used on ChatGPT in Q2 2025 were related to lifestyle and entertainment.

Sensor Tower noted that ChatGPT is gaining users across both mobile apps and platforms. It said that more than 15% of ChatGPT users in the U.S. access it across the web and mobile, higher than other platforms like Temu and Threads. While ChatGPT has shown progress, it is still behind other platforms like Google, Facebook, YouTube, Google Docs, and Amazon, which have more than 25% of users accessing the service both on the web and mobile.

Apps are adding “AI,” literally

The intelligence firm said in its report that the term AI now appears over 100,000 times in app descriptions on both the App Store and the Play Store. Users downloaded apps mentioning AI 7.5 billion times in H1 2025, which accounted for around 10% overall downloads.

In the last 12 months, a growing number of apps in categories like AI assistant, AI content generation, Photo Editing, Nutrition & Diet, Test Prep, Tutoring & Studying, Translation, and Other Hobbies & Interest Services have added AI-related terms.

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An increasing number of apps in the top charts for different categories now have “AI” in their names. However, this addition only has a short-term boost in downloads.

Median Download Growth vs. Month Before Adding AI-Related Terms

Worldwide



IMAGE CREDITS:SENSOR TOWER

“Unsurprisingly, apps that added terms like ‘AI’ or ‘LLM’ to their app names or descriptions experienced a notable boost in downloads over the subsequent months,” Sensor Tower said.

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously worked at publications including Huffington Post and The...

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OpenAI's GPT-5 is here

Maxwell Zeff — 10:00 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

GPT-5 Flagship model

OpenAI has launched GPT-5, a new flagship AI model that will power the company's next generation of ChatGPT.

GPT-5, which was released Thursday, is OpenAI's first "unified" AI model and combines the reasoning abilities of its [o-series](#) of models with the fast responses of its [GPT series](#). The next-generation model signals a new era for ChatGPT — and its creator, OpenAI — pointing to OpenAI's broader ambitions to develop AI systems that are [more like agents](#) than chatbots.

While [GPT-4](#) enabled AI chatbots to offer smart responses on a wide variety of questions, GPT-5 allows ChatGPT to complete a wide variety of tasks on behalf of users — such as generating software applications, navigating a user's calendar, or creating research briefs.

With GPT-5, OpenAI has also sought to make ChatGPT simpler to use. Instead of asking users to choose the right settings, GPT-5 comes equipped with a real-time router that decides how to offer the best answer, whether that's responding to user questions quickly or taking additional time to "think" through answers.

GPT-5
Flagship model

Stronger coding capabilities

Advanced creative writing skills

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During a briefing with reporters, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman claimed GPT-5 is “the best model in the world,” and said it represented a “significant step” along the company’s path to developing AI that can outperform humans at most economically valuable work — that is, artificial general intelligence (AGI).

“Having something like GPT-5 would be pretty much unimaginable at any previous time in history,” said Altman.

Starting Thursday, GPT-5 will be available to all free users of ChatGPT as their default model. OpenAI’s VP of ChatGPT, Nick Turley, said this is part of the company’s effort to give free users access to an AI reasoning model for the first time. (Previously, the company gated these more advanced models behind a paywall.)

“This is just one of the ways that I’m excited to live the mission, making sure that this stuff actually benefits people,” said Turley on the decision, referencing OpenAI’s long-standing [mission](#) to distribute advanced AI to as many people as possible.

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The expectations are high for GPT-5, one of OpenAI’s most anticipated product launches since ChatGPT put the company on the map in 2022. Since then, ChatGPT has grown into one of the world’s most popular consumer products, reaching more than 700 million users every week — nearly 10% of the globe’s population, according to the company.

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Many see GPT-5 as a bellwether for AI progress broadly, and the model's reception by Silicon Valley could have profound implications for Big Tech, Wall Street, and policymakers regulating technology. These stakeholders are watching to see if GPT-5 offers a significant jump in AI's capabilities, much like its predecessor, GPT-4, which challenged expectations of what software can do.

GPT-5 offers a slight edge on the competition

OpenAI claims GPT-5 is state-of-the-art in several domains, slightly edging out leading AI models from Anthropic, Google DeepMind, and Elon Musk's xAI on key benchmarks. However, GPT-5 slightly underperforms frontier AI models in other areas.

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The company says GPT-5 offers frontier-level performance around coding; Altman said the model specifically excels at spinning up entire software applications on demand, in what's become known as "vibe coding."

On SWE-bench Verified — a test of real-world coding tasks pulled from GitHub — GPT-5 scores 74.9% on its first attempt. That means GPT-5 just outperforms Anthropic's latest Claude Opus 4.1 model, which scored [74.5%](#), and Google DeepMind's Gemini 2.5 Pro, which scored [59.6%](#).

On Humanity's Last Exam — a difficult test measuring AI model performance across math, humanities, and the natural sciences — a version of GPT-5 with extended reasoning (GPT-5 Pro) scored 42% when using tools. That's slightly less than xAI was able to achieve with [Grok 4 Heavy](#), which scored 44.4% on the test.

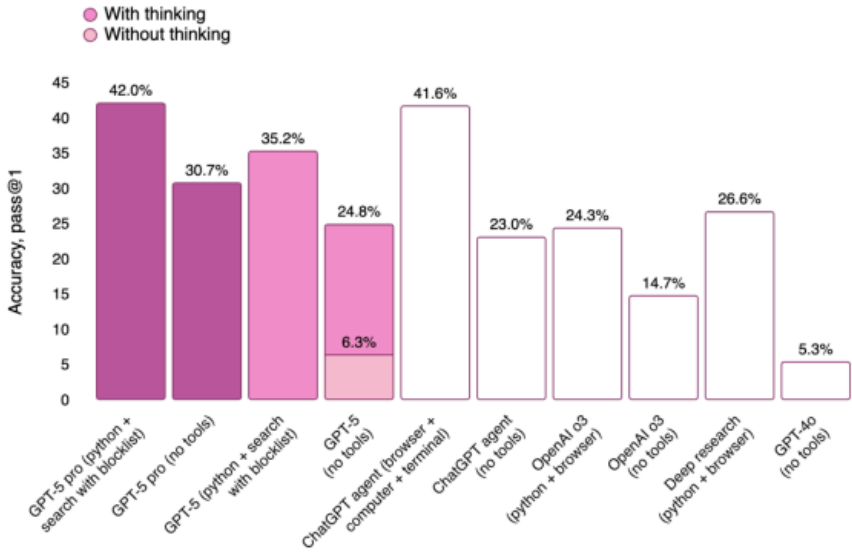


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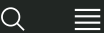
On GPQA Diamond — a test of PhD-level science questions — GPT-5 pro scored 89.4% on its first try, outperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 80.9%, and Grok 4 Heavy, which scored 88.9%.

OpenAI says GPT-5 is better for answering health-related questions. On a test measuring accuracy in AI model responses around healthcare topics, HealthBench Hard Hallucinations, OpenAI says GPT-5 (with thinking) hallucinates just 1.6% of the time. This is far lower than the company’s previous GPT-4o and o3 models, which scored 12.9% and 15.8, respectively.

While AI chatbots are not medical professionals, [millions of people](#) are using them for health advice. In response to this phenomenon, the company says GPT-5 is more proactive about flagging potential health concerns and helping users parse medical results.

In addition, OpenAI says GPT-5 is better than other AI models on more difficult-to-measure, [subjective domains](#), such as creative design and writing. Turley said GPT-5 responds more naturally and exhibits “better

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On a benchmark measuring an AI model’s agentic ability to complete simulated online tasks, Tau-bench, GPT-5 offers mixed performance. On part of the test measuring an AI’s ability to navigate an airline’s website, GPT-5 scores 63.5%, slightly underperforming o3, which scored 64.8%. On another part of the test measuring AI’s ability to navigate retail websites, GPT-5 scores 81.1%, underperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 82.4%.

OpenAI also says that GPT-5 is safer than its previous models. While AI reasoning models occasionally exhibit a tendency to [scheme against humans](#) or lie to promote their own goals, OpenAI found that GPT-5 was deceptive at a lower rate than other models.

Alex Beutel, OpenAI’s safety research lead, said reducing deception improves not only the safety of GPT-5, but also the user experience, creating a model that’s more “transparent and honest in ways users can trust.”

Beutel also notes GPT-5 is better at discerning between bad actors who are trying to misuse ChatGPT and users making harmless requests. This results in GPT-5 being able to refuse more unsafe questions, while offering fewer rejections to users seeking harmless information.

Upgrades for consumers and developers

ChatGPT is getting a few user experience upgrades as part of the GPT-5 launch. Users can now select from four new personalities in ChatGPT’s setting: Cynic, Robot, Listener, and Nerd. The company says these will adapt ChatGPT’s responses without requiring users to specifically ask the model to respond in a certain way.

Subscribers to ChatGPT’s \$20-per-month Plus plan get higher usage limits for GPT-5 than free users. Meanwhile, \$200-per-month Pro subscribers will have unlimited access to GPT-5, as well as a souped-up version called GPT-5 Pro that uses additional computational resources to produce better answers. Organizations on OpenAI’s Team, Edu, and Enterprise plans will gain access to GPT-5 as their default model next week.

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For developers, GPT-5 is coming to OpenAI’s API in three sizes — gpt-5, gpt-5-mini, and gpt-5-nano — which will spend more or less time “reasoning” through tasks. Developers can also now control verbosity in the OpenAI API, deciding how long or short an AI model’s responses should be.

The base model of GPT-5 will cost developers \$1.25 per million input tokens (roughly 750,000 words, longer than the entire “Lord of the Rings” series) and \$10 per million output tokens.

The launch of GPT-5 comes after a busy week for OpenAI. The company released an open-weight reasoning model, [gpt-oss](#), that developers and enterprises can download for free and run at a fraction of the cost. The open model nearly matched the abilities of OpenAI’s previous top models, o3 and o4-mini, but GPT-5 sets a new standard for frontier performance in some areas, such as coding.

However, GPT-5 seems to be roughly on par with other frontier AI models in several areas. Benchmarks, of course, only tell part of the story for any AI model, and it remains to be seen how developers will use GPT-5 in the real world, and whether the model is truly a step above the competition.

Topics: [AI](#) [ChatGPT](#) [gpt-5](#) [OpenAI](#)

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Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter | [X](#)

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg, and MSNBC, Zeff has covered the rise of AI and the Silicon...

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Qwant and Ecosia debut
Staan, a European search
index that aims to take on Big
Tech

European search engines Qwant and Ecosia said on Wednesday that they have both started sending search queries through an index they developed together, [Staan](#), which aims to be a cheaper, more privacy-focused alternative to Google and Bing.

Last year, French privacy-focused search engine Qwant struck a joint venture with German non-profit search engine Ecosia to develop [a European search index](#). Called European Search Perspective (EUSP), the JV now aims to serve around 50% of French queries and 33% of German queries by the end of the year.

Qwant said it is using the new index to power some of its features, like AI summaries for search, and Ecosia has plans to add some AI features soon to its platform, too.

IMAGE CREDITS: MIRAGEC / GETTY IMAGES

EUSP is also in talks with companies to spur the adoption of its index for enabling search within apps. Notably, it is targeting chatbots, presenting Staas as a cheaper alternative to Google and Bing.

“If you’re using ChatGPT or any other AI chatbot, they all do knowledge grounding with web search ... our index can power deep research and AI summary features. Google and Bing’s solutions are also pricey, and our index can offer power search features at a tenth of the cost,” Christian Kroll, CEO of Ecosia, told TechCrunch.

EUSP, like [Proton](#), is pushing to develop a European tech stack that doesn’t rely on technology from the U.S. or China.

“The timing could not be more urgent. The outcome of the 2024 U.S. election has reminded European policymakers and innovators just how exposed Europe remains when it comes to core digital infrastructure. Much of Europe’s search, cloud, and AI layers are built on American Big Tech stacks, putting entire sectors — from journalism to climate tech — at the mercy of political or commercial agendas,” the companies said in a statement.

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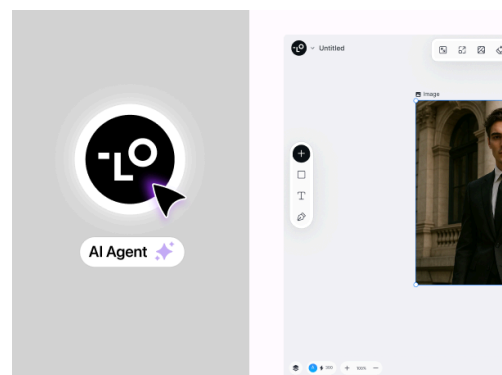
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Kroll added that through this index, combined with European privacy laws, EUSP can offer a more privacy-friendly search solution as compared to its U.S. counterparts.

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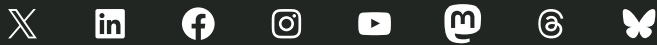
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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously worked at publications including Huffington Post and The...

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